

Life in the 1860s: Settling the West Note Guide

Warm-Up (Slide 2)

Describe in your own words what life was like in the United States during the 1860s. Be as specific as you can be. How did most people live? What was going on in politics? What is society like?

Manifest Destiny (Slides 3, 4, and 5)

As you watch the video about Manifest Destiny, write down at least 3 things you learned:

Life in the 1860s:

RURAL =

URBAN =

Life Transformed:

How does _____, _____, & _____ change life for people living during this time period?

TECHNOLOGY + MANIFEST DESTINY = _____ (Slides 6, 7, 8, 9)

_____ = streets, roads, transportation

Why do we need to connect California to the rest of the nation?

What do we want to happen to the land in between?

What major US event INTERRUPTS the building of this railroad?

RAILROADS IN THE 1860S (Slide 10)

Limited & concentrated in the North & East → WHY???

Short & Numerous → rates vary, no standard gauge, AND no _____

Why does telling time become a concern?

THE TRANSCONTINENTAL RR (pt. 1) → _____ **miles of track** (Slide 11)

_____ (from Omaha, Nebraska to the WEST)

_____ (from Sacramento, California to the EAST)

_____ & _____ at stake...

THE TRANSCONTINENTAL RR (pt. 2) (Slides 12 and 13)

- Central Pacific hires _____ (Why?)
- Union Pacific hires _____ and _____ (Why?)
- The TCRR was finished _____ in _____, _____.

SETTLING THE WEST → _____ ACT OF 1862 (Slide 13)

- By 1900 there were _____ transcontinental railroads
- Need to settle land previously owned by France and Spain...they didn't colonize, so it's up for grabs!
- Gov't has to motivate people to go into the wilderness → dream of "free land"
- Remember...LAND = _____
- Gov't provides _____ acres for \$ _____ (\$389/2025) → must *cultivate* the land for 5 years (*Why 5 yrs?*)
- Between 1862-1900 _____ people moved West (many from other countries)
- What additional innovation changed the landscape of the West?
- Ends the _____.

THE TRANSCONTINENTAL RR RESULTS (Slide 14)

- Economic Consequences
- Geographic Consequences
- Time Zones

George Pullman (Slide 15)

- How is he connected to the railroad? What did he develop?
- Why was his company/development important to train travel?

BUT WHERE DID WE GET ALL THIS LAND? (Slides 16 and 17)

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